

finding one in high school, only now you may have a longer résumé and are over 18. This means you have more paths open to you—you can legally bartend, for one. Bartending requires taking a class and getting a mixology certification. Some of these classes can cost \$200 to \$500, though some have special deals available. Usually these classes are spread out and run forty hours. There are different schools with different levels of credibility. Bartending can be a good job during college, but the income isn't stable. Plus, my sister, who worked as a waitress at a bar, said it kept her out late hours. That's hard when you also have classes.

My girlfriend currently works at her college, which also gives her a discount on tuition. Some graduate students work as teaching assistants for the same reason. She manages a building, working during the day and taking mostly night classes when she can. This has been great for having a job during school and for not having to travel far for class, but it's a bit stressful because it's a full-time job while being a full-time student.

I was lucky to be one of the small number of people who had a part-time job in college that was in the field I wanted to go into. But pursuing my ideal career path led to some tough financial decisions.



The summer before senior year, I landed my dream internship at *The Daily Show with Jon Stewart* in New York City.

The internship was organized through the show's parent company Viacom, which encompasses networks like VH1, Comedy Central, and MTV. I was obsessed with *The Daily Show* and with Mr. Stewart—so much so that for my 18th birthday, my mom wrote to him using an address she'd found online (probably that of his manager) and he'd sent back a personalized signed photo, which hung in my bedroom for years. An essay I'd written about my aspiration to work for the show had been published in a 2006 anthology of the best writing by high school students. Being offered this internship was the pinnacle of my life's work. I had to take it.